STEM Career Exploration 🚀

Cadette STEM Badge — Girls Build Bots

Presented by your robotics mentors

Career exploration gets practical

You're close enough to high school that the real questions are:

- What do STEM jobs **actually involve**, day to day?
- What's the **pathway** — classes, clubs, degrees?
- What can you do **this year** that counts?

Our honest answer: we're on that pathway right now. Here's what it looks like.

Myth vs. Day-in-the-Life 

Read your career card. Report the **surprise**:

What does this job actually involve — vs. the TV version?

- Software engineers spend more time **reading** code than writing it
- Scientists spend a *lot* of time **writing**

Choose the Tuesdays, not the highlight reel 

Every career looks good in a montage.

Choosing one means knowing what its ordinary Tuesday feels like.

The Panel — Cadette Edition 🎤

Three minutes each, with the practical layer:

- What **classes** we chose, and why
- How we **joined** the team
- What we're aiming for **after high school**
- One **honest struggle**

Then ask us hard questions. You will — we're ready.

Informational Interviews 

The badge's core skill, done for real.

In pairs, **8 minutes** with a team member:

1. What does your role involve?
2. What surprised you?
3. What would you tell someone my age?
4. What's the next step on your path?

Take notes. Then rotate.

Why this skill matters 💼

Interviewing a person about their path is a career skill you'll use **for decades**.

Not a workshop exercise. The actual thing.

Your Pathway Map 🗺️

career interest

↓

NOW — a club, a free course, FLL/FTC, a science fair

↓

HIGH SCHOOL — classes, teams

↓

AFTER

It’s a draft, not a contract

Paths change.

The panel you just heard is the proof.

Commit 🎯

Share: 1. Your **now-step** 2. **When** you'll take it

"Someday" doesn't count. "FLL signup by Friday" does.

Robot moment 🤖

Take the controls. Drive it.

Every person who built this started with a step exactly the size of the one on your map.

What you accomplished ✅

- Described the realistic day-to-day of at least two STEM careers
- Conducted an informational interview and recorded what you learned
- Mapped a pathway from a career interest back to actions you can take now
- Committed to one concrete next step with a timeframe

Level up 🚀

- Take your now-step **on the date you named**
- Run one more informational interview — anyone, any field
- Keep the pathway map. Revise it when it changes. It will.

📣 Share Your Impact

Troop leaders & robotics teams — if you used this curriculum, please:

1. **Credit us** — the curriculum comes from **Girls Build Bots**
2. **Tag us** — **@girlsbuildbots** on Instagram
3. **Report your results** — email **girlsbuildbots@gmail.com** with how many girls took part, how many badges were earned, and how it went

This is how the program grows — and how the next troop and team get better materials.